CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE CHAPTER TEST SET A

Chapter 3: **The Rise of the Marathas** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Draw neat maps and diagrams wherever required.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The Marathas are people native to the: 1

(a) Gangetic plain **(b)** Deccan plateau (present-day Maharashtra)

(c) Malabar coast only **(d)** Thar desert

2. The bhakti saints helped by translating the Upanishads and Gita into: 1

(a) Persian **(b)** Urdu **(c)** Marathi **(d)** English

3. Shivaji's vision of a sovereign kingdom was called: 1

(a) Sulh-i-kul **(b)** Swarajya **(c)** Iqta **(d)** Jauhar

4. The Mughal nobleman who invaded Maharashtra and lost fingers in a night raid was: 1

(a) Jai Singh **(b)** Ram Singh **(c)** Shaista Khan **(d)** Afzal Khan

5. Shivaji was crowned at Raigad in: 1

(a) 1646 **(b)** 1674 **(c)** 1630 **(d)** 1680

6. After Shivaji, the Chhatrapati was first: 1

(a) Sambhaji **(b)** Tarabai **(c)** Rajaram **(d)** Bajirao

7. Pan-Indian expansion was driven by Peshwa Bajirao I and his son: 1

(a) Shahu **(b)** Sambhaji **(c)** Madhavrao II **(d)** Nanasaheb Peshwa

8. The council of eight ministers was the: 1

(a) Sabha **(b)** Ashta Pradhana Mandala

(c) Diwan-i-Khas **(d)** Navaratna

9. In Maratha cavalry, shiledars: 1

(a) served in the navy **(b)** were paid horses by the state

(c) provided their own horses and equipment **(d)** were priests

10. **Assertion (A):** Shivaji built a navy, a revolutionary step at the time. 1

Reason (R): He needed to secure coastal resources on the west coast.

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

(c) A is true but R is false

(d) A is false but R is true

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 10–15 words each.

11. Who were the Marathas? 2

12. Name two Maratha bhakti saints. 2

13. Why did Shivaji create a navy? 2

14. Describe the Afzal Khan episode in two lines. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

15. Explain the bhakti foundation of Maratha society. 3

16. Describe Shivaji's early life and rise. 3

17. Describe the building and importance of the Maratha navy. 3

OR

Describe three famous episodes of Shivaji's struggle with Bijapur and the Mughals. 3

18. Describe the escape from Agra. 3

OR

Explain the importance of Shivaji's coronation. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

19. Describe the foundation of Maratha power and Shivaji's rise from childhood to coronation. 5

OR

Describe any four episodes of Shivaji's career: Afzal Khan, Shaista Khan, Surat, Purandar and Agra. 5

20. Explain the administration of Shivaji: civil, taxes, military and judiciary. 5

OR

Name the ministers of the Ashta Pradhana Mandala with their portfolios and explain its importance. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND